

THE DAILY BRIEF

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AI & TECH

Latest in artificial intelligence, models, and technology

Index Ventures Co-Founder Neil Rimer Says AI Wealth Will Have to Be Redistributed. In one of the sharpest public critiques from inside the venture capital establishment, Neil Rimer — the co-founder of Index Ventures, whose portfolio includes UiPath, Figma, and Robinhood — told TechCrunch that the historic wealth AI is generating in Silicon Valley will eventually have to be redistributed, whether willingly or through regulatory pressure. Rimer didn't offer a timeline, but his remarks landed in the middle of an increasingly polarized debate about whether AI profits are being fairly distributed across society. Index Ventures has been one of the most active AI investors in Europe and North America, and Rimer's comments carry extra weight because he rarely speaks publicly about macro-level wealth dynamics. The implication: VCs are aware the current AI value capture is concentrated at the model layer and infrastructure providers, and that pressure will build to widen the aperture.

Databricks Hits \$188 Billion Valuation, Cementing AI's "Second Act" for Enterprise Data Companies. Databricks — the data lakehouse company founded by the original creators of Apache Spark — has remade itself into one of AI's most important infrastructure plays, publishing research on the cost savings of open-weight AI models for coding and landing a valuation that puts it in rarefied air alongside OpenAI and Anthropic on private markets. The company positioned itself as the place where enterprises go to train and deploy AI on their own data, a narrative that has resonated as corporates look to move beyond generic chatbot demos to real workflow integration. With \$188 billion in valuation, Databricks has successfully made the case that legacy data infrastructure companies can have a second life as AI platforms — a thesis that has also lifted Snowflake and Databricks rivals alike.

Agility Robotics Opens Digit Robot Training Center in Fremont, California — Steps From Tesla's Gigafactory. Agility, the Oregon-based robotics firm behind the humanoid robot Digit, has planted its flag in Tesla's backyard with a new training and development facility in Fremont, California. The location is not accidental: Fremont is where Tesla assembles its EVs, and the proximity signals Agility's ambition to compete for the kind of factory-floor automation contracts Tesla has hinted it wants to develop in-house. Digit is already being tested in logistics and warehouse environments, and the Fremont facility will accelerate training on real-world industrial tasks. For robotics bulls, this is evidence that the humanoid robot wave is moving from PowerPoint to pilot program faster than skeptics expected.

Apple and Google Ordered to Remove "Nudify" Apps From App Stores. San Francisco City Attorney David Chiu sent formal letters to both Apple and Google demanding the removal of apps that use AI to create non-consensual nude images, citing years of awareness that these apps were generating revenue on their platforms. Official estimates suggest both companies likely collected millions in fees from these applications. The action puts pressure on both app stores to implement more rigorous AI content screening — a technically challenging task given how quickly image generation models evolve — and sets up a broader legal fight about platform liability for AI-generated harm. The letters are a precursor to likely legislation in California that would hold app stores strictly liable for hosting such tools.

MARKETS & FINANCE

Major market moves and financial news

Bitcoin Falls Near \$63,000 as Chip Stocks Sell Off; Coinbase Premium Stays Negative for Record 60 Days. Bitcoin slipped toward the \$63,000 level on Friday as a broad selloff in semiconductor stocks — led by Nvidia continuing its recent volatility — weighed on risk assets across the board. The more worrying signal for Bitcoin purists: the Coinbase premium, which measures the gap between Bitcoin's price on Coinbase versus Binance, has now been negative for 60 consecutive days — a record streak. A negative Coinbase premium typically means US buyers are more cautious or that institutional flow into US-regulated venues is lagging. ETF flows remain thin, with BlackRock's IBIT yet to reclaim the momentum it had in earlier cycles. For context: a 60-day negative streak has no modern precedent and suggests the current cycle's institutional demand is behaving differently than bulls had hoped.

Michael Saylor's Strategy Needs Clearer Bitcoin Accounting Rules, Says CryptoQuant. CryptoQuant, the on-chain analytics firm, published research this week arguing that Michael Saylor's Strategy (formerly MicroStrategy) needs more transparent rules for when it buys and sells Bitcoin to maintain the accounting treatment that has allowed it to carry BTC at cost rather than market value. Under current policy, Strategy treats Bitcoin as an indefinite-lived intangible asset — which lets it avoid impairment charges that would otherwise hit its balance sheet — but only if it doesn't trade it like a financial asset. As Strategy accumulates more BTC and its subsidiaries engage in more active treasury management, CryptoQuant argues the lines are blurring. Strategy has spent months accumulating over 500,000 Bitcoin worth roughly \$30 billion at current prices, making it the largest publicly-traded Bitcoin holder in the world.

Mt. Gox Bankruptcy Estate Has Now Distributed Nearly \$10 Billion to Creditors Since 2025. The Mt. Gox trustee announced that the collapsed Bitcoin exchange's bankruptcy estate has distributed nearly \$10 billion to creditors and other claimants since repayments began in 2025 — one of the largest restitution processes in financial history. Mt. Gox failed in 2014 when roughly 850,000 Bitcoin went missing, and creditors have been waiting over a decade for recovery. The massive distribution has been a source of anxiety for Bitcoin markets, as creditors have historically been assumed to sell upon receipt. That concern has moderated somewhat: some creditors chose repayment in BTC rather than fiat, and the fact that Bitcoin has held \$60,000+ through the bulk of the distribution schedule suggests demand has absorbed the selling pressure. But at nearly \$10 billion in total distributions, the estate remains a significant overhang if any large creditors have yet to fully liquidate.

Bank of America Taps New Leadership at the Intersection of Crypto and AI. Bank of America made two significant internal moves this week: Sonali Theisen was named head of BoFA's global digital assets platform, while Kevin Milsom was tapped as head of AI transformation. The simultaneous appointments signal that the bank's senior leadership sees crypto infrastructure and AI integration as parallel priorities rather than competing initiatives. BoFA has been one of the more cautious large US banks on crypto, but Theisen's brief will likely include expanding the bank's Ethereum-based tokenization work and exploring permissioned blockchain settlement systems. The bank is also a founding member of the OFR's digital asset working group, and these appointments suggest BoFA is done waiting to see how regulation develops — it's building the team now.

Bitcoin ETF IBIT Briefly Surpassed \$100 Billion in Assets, Evoking GLD's 2011 Trajectory. BlackRock's Bitcoin ETF IBIT briefly crossed the \$100 billion AUM mark this week — a milestone that took GLD, the gold ETF, years to reach. Bloomberg ETF analyst Eric Balchunas noted the comparison: GLD took a far more gradual path to \$100 billion, while IBIT achieved it in a fraction of the time, reflecting the different investor bases and velocity of capital that digital asset funds attract. The comparison is imperfect — gold has a 6,000-year store of value history; Bitcoin is 15 years old — but the speed of institutional adoption, at least at the ETF layer, has been remarkable. The qualifier "briefly" matters: IBIT has since pulled back below \$100B as the broader crypto selloff weighed on flows.

BRIEFLY

◀ **Privacy Developer ZachXBT Warns Hardware Wallets Aren't Safe for Signing Transactions or Fund Storage.** The pseudonymous blockchain researcher wrote this week that hardware wallets — long considered the gold standard for crypto self-custody — carry underappreciated risks when used to sign transactions regularly. "I do not advise using them for important tasks like signing transactions or storing funds," ZachXBQ wrote, without elaborating on specific firmware vulnerabilities. The warning is notable coming from a researcher whose on-chain investigations have exposed multiple exit scams and exchange failures.

THE TAKEAWAY

The defining tension of this moment is that Bitcoin's fundamentals are strong — institutional adoption through ETFs is real, bankrupt estates are distributing billions back to creditors, and legacy banks are building actual crypto infrastructure — yet the price is struggling. The Coinbase premium's unprecedented 60-day negative streak tells you that US retail and institutional demand isn't showing up at the same pace as overseas buyers, and the chip-stock contagion is reminding markets that Bitcoin still trades as a risk asset more than a safe haven. Meanwhile in AI, the real action has shifted from model companies to infrastructure plays like Databricks and to the messy regulatory questions that come after the boom — app store accountability, wealth redistribution, and robotics moving from lab to factory floor. The AI story is maturing, which means the easy narratives are over.

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